Alisa Liao

510-335-9817 | alisaliao45@gmail.com | https://alisaliao45-hash.github.io/Personal-Website/ | San Diego, CA

Education

University of California San Diego, Revelle College Expected June 2028
B.S. in Cognitive Science GPA: **3.958** *La Jolla, CA*
Coursework: Research Methods, Cognitive Consequences of Technology, Data Science in Practice, Neurobiology of Cognition

Mission San Jose High School June 2025
Valedictorian | 150+ Service Hours *Fremont, CA*

Technical Skills

Design: Product Design, Interaction Design, Visual Design, UI/UX Design, Prototyping, User-Centered Design, Design Systems
Research: User Research, User Interviews, Usability Testing, Task Analysis, Data Analysis, Experiment Design
Tools: Figma, Adobe Photoshop, Qualtrics, Claude Code | **Languages**: Python, Java, JavaScript, HTML, CSS

Experience

Design Consultant Oct 2026 – Present
Cornerstone Community Consultants, UC San Diego *La Jolla, CA*
- Redesign websites and logos for small businesses, bridging client strategy with polished visual design execution
- Analyze client data and trends with consultant team, translating insights into product and design recommendations

Protolab Research Intern Oct 2026 – Present
Design Lab, UC San Diego *La Jolla, CA*
- Help design a 0-to-1 AI-powered creative tool that guides novice designers to articulate user needs and values
- Prototype and iterate on low-fidelity designs, defining a 2×2 experiment to test which version best improves learning

Design For America IDEA Board Lead June 2026 – Present
Design For America, UC San Diego *La Jolla, CA*
- Lead a design education program for 50+ UCSD students, teaching user-centered design, prototyping, and visual design
- Run workshops on Figma, usability testing, design systems, and project management that help emerging designers grow

Research Assistant Jan 2026 – Sep 2026
Emotions and Empathy Lab, UC San Diego *La Jolla, CA*
- Facilitated experiment sessions for a social psychology study, guiding participants through protocols for unbiased data
- Built a codebook standardizing survey variables, streamlining data analysis and ensuring consistency across datasets

UX Designer Jan 2026 – July 2026
To Be Designed, UC San Diego *La Jolla, CA*
- Redesigned the website of a nonprofit photography exhibition end to end, from user research to high-fidelity prototypes
- Communicated design decisions clearly to the client and used their feedback to refine designs across iterations

Music and Art Branch Director & Volunteer Tutor Aug 2021 – Jul 2025
BOBtutor *Remote*
- Directed nonprofit's Music and Art Branch, promoting access to arts education for children and raising $2,000+

Projects

Belidor Case Study | *Interaction Design, Creativity Support Tools* Sep 2026 – Present
- Lead an independent project under graduate mentorship, building a creativity support tool for observational drawing
- Use the Belidor specification language to apply analogical thinking and explore novel interface concepts for creators

Brilliance Exposed Website Redesign | *Visual Design, User Research, Prototyping* Jan 2026 – July 2026
- Shaped the branding of a nonprofit photography exhibition, creating a cohesive visual identity to showcase its artists
- Ran user interviews, task analyses, and usability tests, turning insights into interaction and visual design decisions
- Built high-fidelity Figma prototypes with team, improving aesthetics, usability, and professional appearance

Fremont BoxART! Public Art | *Visual Design, Painting* May – Jul 2024
- Selected by City of Fremont to design and paint a public electrical box as part of a citywide beautification initiative
- Created visually compelling design promoting sustainability and upcycling for a community engagement program